

EDUCATION

Northwestern University Ph.D. in Computer Science, Advisor: Sam Kriegman	Evanston, IL, USA Sept. 2023 – Present
University of Texas, Austin M.Sc. in Computer Science, Advisor: David Harwath Thesis: <i>Phoneme Segmentation Using Self-Supervised Speech Models</i>	Austin, TX, USA Aug. 2021 – Aug. 2023
University of California, Berkeley B.A. in Computer Science	Berkeley, CA, USA Aug. 2014 – May 2018

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Google, Paradigms of Intelligence Team Student Researcher	Zurich, CHE Feb. 2025 – Jul. 2025
Skywalk AI (now Subtle Computing) AI Engineer	Palo Alto, CA, USA Jun. 2022 – Jan. 2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Xenobot Lab Center for Robotics and Biosystems; Northwestern University Graduate Research Staff	Evanston, IL, USA Sept. 2023 – Present
Speech Audio & Language Technologies Lab Department of Computer Science; University of Texas, Austin Graduate Research Assistant	Austin, TX, USA Oct. 2021 – Aug. 2023
Quantitative Bioimaging Lab Knight Cancer Institute; Oregon Health & Science University Research Software Engineer	Portland, OR, USA Sept. 2021 – Aug. 2022
Gardner Lab Knight Campus for Accelerating Scientific Impact; University of Oregon Post-Bacc Research Assistant	Eugene, OR, USA Jun. 2020 – Jun. 2021
Remais Lab Department of Public Health; University of California, Berkeley Undergraduate Research Assistant	Berkeley, CA, USA Jun. 2020 – Jun. 2021

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **L. Strgar** and S. Kriegman, “Accelerated co-design of robots through morphological pretraining,” in *Proceedings of the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026.
- [2] **L. Strgar**, D. Matthews, T. Hummer, and S. Kriegman, “Evolution and learning in differentiable robots,” in *Robotics: Science and Systems*, 2024.

- [3] Z. Sims, **L. Strgar**, D. Thirumalaisamy, R. Heussner, G. Thibault, and Y. H. Chang, "Segmentation Evaluation in absence of Ground truth labels," *bioRxiv*, 2023.
- [4] **L. Strgar** and D. Harwath, "Phoneme Segmentation Using Self-Supervised Speech Models," in *2022 IEEE Spoken Language Technology Workshop (SLT)*, 2023.
- [5] M. S. Parappilly, Y. Chin, R. M. Whalen, A. N. Anderson, T. S. Robinson, **L. Strgar**, T. L. Sutton, P. Conley, C. Klocke, S. L. Gibbs, Y. H. Chang, G. Wu, M. H. Wong, and A. H. Skalet, "Circulating Neoplastic-Immune Hybrid Cells Predict Metastatic Progression in Uveal Melanoma," *Cancers*, 2022.
- [6] C. M. Hoover, S. L. Rumschlag, **L. Strgar**, A. Arakala, M. Gambhir, G. A. de Leo, S. H. Sokolow, J. R. Rohr, and J. V. Remais, "Effects of agrochemical pollution on schistosomiasis transmission: a systematic review and modelling analysis," *The Lancet Planetary Health*, 2020.

TEACHING

- **Teaching Assistant** at Northwestern University Winter 2026
Artificial Life (COMP_SCI 396)
- **Graduate Instructor** at Northwestern University Fall 2025
Evolutionary Computation (COMP_SCI 496)

MENTORSHIP

- **Gary Li**, BS in Computer Science & Math at Northwestern University Jan. 2026 – Present
- **Adwait Ganguly**, BS/MS in Computer Science at Northwestern University Jan. 2026 – Present
- **Daniel Killioğlu**, BS/MS in Mechanical Engineering at Northwestern University Jan. 2026 – Present